These recommendations of the committee were accepted by the National Development Council in January 1958. The council did not insist on a single rigid pattern and left it to the states to evolve their own patterns suitable to local conditions. But the basic principles and broad fundamentals should be identical throughout the country.

Rajasthan was the first state to establish Panchayati Raj. The scheme was inaugurated by the prime minister on October 2, 1959, in Nagaur district. Rajasthan was followed by Andhra Pradesh, which also adopted the system in 1959. Thereafter, most of the states adopted the system.

Though most of the states created Panchayati Raj institutions by the mid 1960s, there were differences from one state to another with regard to the number of tiers, relative position of samiti and parishad, their tenure, composition, functions, finances and so on. For example, Rajasthan adopted the three-tier system while Tamil Nadu adopted the two-tier system. West Bengal, on the other hand, adopted the four-tier system. Further, in the Rajasthan–Andhra Pradesh pattern, panchayat samiti was powerful as the block was the unit of planning and development, while in Maharashtra–Gujarat pattern, zila parishad was powerful as the district was the unit of planning and development. Some states also established nyaya panchayats, that is, judicial panchayats to try petty civil and criminal cases.



Study Teams and Committees

Since 1960, many study teams, committees and working groups have been appointed to examine the various aspects of functioning of Panchayati Raj system. They are mentioned in Table 39.1.

Table 39.1 Study Teams and Committees on Panchayati Raj

Sl. No.	Year	Name of the study Team / Committee	Chairman
1.	1960	Committee on Rationalisation of Panchayat Statistics	V.R. Rao
2.	1961	Working Group on Panchayats and Cooperatives	S.D. Mishra
3.	1961	Study Team on Panchayati Raj Administration	V. Iswaran
4.	1962	Study Team on Nyaya Panchayats	G.R. Rajgopal
5.	1963	Study Team on the Position of Gram Sabha in Panchayati Raj Movement	R.R. Diwakar
6.	1963	Study Group on Budgeting and Accounting Procedure of Panchayati Raj Institutions	M. Rama Krishnayya